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Education

PhD in Economics 2023 – 2027 (expected)
Tilburg University *Tilburg, NL*

Research Master in Economics 2021 – 2023
Tilburg University — Cum Laude *Tilburg, NL*

Master of Science in Economics 2019 – 2021
Universidade de Brasília (UnB) — Grade: SS out of SS, equivalent to 4.0 GPA *Brasilia, BR*

Bachelor of Arts in Economics 2014 – 2018
Universidade Federal da Bahia (UFBA) — Grade: 9.3 out of 10 *Salvador, BR*
Academic Year Abroad, Universidad de Santiago de Compostela, ES *2016 – 2017*

Research Interests

Macroeconomics, Monetary Economics, Development Economics

Research Visits

Visiting Scholar 2025
University of Pennsylvania *Philadelphia, US*

Job Market Paper

New-Keynesian Open-Market Operations: A Reassessment of the Role of Money

Abstract: Quantitative New Keynesian models typically abstract from money, on the grounds that it plays no quantitative role in monetary policy transmission or optimal policy. This paper shows that money matters for the outcomes of monetary policy through the open market operations (OMO) that implement it. Empirically, I construct a new series of Federal Reserve permanent OMO from weekly reports (1979–2008) and show that open market operations respond significantly to high-frequency identified interest rate shocks within a month and, contrary to existing evidence, more strongly after the Fed began announcing its target rate. I build a heterogeneous-agent New Keynesian model with corporate debt and cash-in-advance constraints under which the central bank must conduct OMO to enforce its interest-rate target. The calibrated model matches the untargeted OMO response. Relative to a cashless benchmark, investment responds about 30% more to a rate cut and household savings fall twice as much, because OMO finance investment through an inflation tax that falls hardest on poorer households. With money, deviations from the optimal Taylor rule are an order of magnitude costlier and output stabilization is unambiguously harmful, as consumption and hours respond strongly to inflation and OMO volume.

Working Papers

The Price of Traceability: E-Payments, Tax Compliance, and Policy (with Burak Uras)

Abstract: Why do firms continue to rely on cash in economies where digital payments are widespread and electronic transaction costs are low? This paper shows that the answer lies in the interaction between payment technologies and tax enforcement. Using randomized experimental evidence from Kenyan small and medium-sized firms, we establish that the adoption of electronic payments causally increases tax compliance by raising transaction traceability. Moreover, SME survey evidence shows that tax evasion is associated with cash discounts. Motivated by these findings, we develop a microfounded general equilibrium model in which heterogeneous firms choose prices, payment acceptance, and tax evasion jointly. Cash facilitates evasion but exposes buyers to transaction risk, while electronic payments are safer yet traceable by third parties. These trade-offs generate endogenous cash discounts, selective rejection of digital payments, and coexistence of payment instruments in equilibrium. The calibrated model shows that when electronic payments are non–interest-bearing, inflation increases cash usage and tax evasion, overturning the standard prediction that inflation reduces cash use. We characterize the optimal policy mix and show that financial development, enforcement intensity, and inflation are tightly intertwined in maximizing government revenues and welfare.

On the Distributional Effects of Monetary Shocks and Market Incompleteness

Abstract: I study the transmission of distortionary monetary policy shocks under incomplete markets. Using a heterogeneous agents general equilibrium model, I demonstrate that there is a unique fundamental stationary equilibrium, where the distribution of monetary holdings mirrors productivity, but infinite non-fundamental stationary equilibria for a given monetary base in the presence of a frictionless bonds market. Only financially constrained economies return to the fundamental stationary equilibrium after an unforeseeable monetary shock that redistributes monetary holdings, with aggregate effects on output and endogenous price stickiness along the transition. Financially developed economies display smaller distortions and negligible effects on aggregate variables, but monetary shocks create hysteresis by making the consequences of idiosyncratic shocks permanent. While partial market completion enhances welfare by enabling nearly perfect risk sharing, this improvement is limited by the irreversibility of the idiosyncratic shocks. Ultimately, distributional effects are irrelevant for monetary policy transmission to aggregate variables in developed economies but critical in poorer countries.

Work in Progress

Business Cycles and Informal Hiring with Misallocation of Capital

Abstract: This paper builds a model of the role of informality along the business cycle in an economy with capital misallocation. The intensive margin is modelled through a size-dependent cost function; the extensive margin, as a separate, low-productivity informal sector whose firms cannot formalize. I find that the intensive margin gives less productive firms a competitive advantage during recessions: informal hiring becomes cheaper as firms shrink, and smaller firms are the most intensive in informal labor. As in prior literature, the intensive margin also absorbs shocks by lowering labor costs, though the effect is quantitatively small. In the calibrated model, eliminating either margin reduces total output. Both VAT and payroll taxes cause intersectorial misallocation, and the latter also favors small, informal-intensive formal firms over large ones.

Grants and Awards

TiSEM Jenny Ligthart Award — Best RM student continuing onto Ph.D., 2022-2023

***Cum Laude*, Research Master in Economics — Tilburg University,** 2021-2023

Koopmans Scholarship 2021-2023

CAPES fellowship for Research Master's Program in Economics 2020-2021

Top student of 2018.2 cohort — Universidade Federal da Bahia 2014-2018

FAPESB Scientific Initiation Scholarship 2015-2016

Skills

Languages: English (Fluent), Spanish (Fluent), Portuguese (Native), Italian (Intermediate), German (Intermediate), Dutch (Basic), Galician (Basic)

Programming / Econometric: Matlab, Python, Stata, Git, HTML (Basic)

Document Creation: LaTeX, Microsoft Office

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant — Business Cycles and Frictions 2025 – 2026
Research Master in Economics, Tilburg University *Tilburg, NL*

Teaching Assistant — Data Science and Society 2024
M.Sc. in Economics, Tilburg University *Tilburg, NL*

Teaching Assistant — Economics for Social Sciences 2024
B.Sc. in Social Sciences, Tilburg University *Tilburg, NL*

Teaching Assistant — Quantitative Dynamic Macroeconomics 2023 – 2026
B.Sc. in Economics, Tilburg University *Tilburg, NL*

Teaching Assistant — Macroeconomics 2 2021
M.Sc in Economics, University of Brasilia *Brasilia, BR*

Teaching Assistant — Topics in Macroeconomics 2021
B.Sc in Economics, University of Brasilia *Brasilia, BR*

Academic Service

Seminar Organizer — Development and Economic History Research Group 2024 – 2025
Tilburg University *Tilburg, NL*

Research Assistant 2015 – 2016
FAPESB Scholarship — Universidade Federal da Bahia *Salvador, BR*

References

Dr. Burak Uras
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Dr. Daniel Sanches
Economic Advisor and Economist
Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia
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